

# Project Scout

Quick Start

Last updated: June 10, 2026 | Version 6

Upload this at the start of EVERY Claude or ChatGPT session about Scout. For full technical details, use the Scout Master Summary (v23).

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## June 10, 2026 — What Is New:

- Business model updated — 7-day free trial, then \$9.99 one-time purchase. No automatic charges. No subscriptions. Ever.
  - Wake word identified as MOST URGENT fix — Scout currently responds to everything including TV and background noise.
  - Wake word must read robot name from TruthDb — not hardcoded — so renamed companions work automatically.
  - Play Store Launch Checklist created — six focused sessions between today and launch.
  - Support Scout screen confirmed — four optional one-time tiers. Ad-free forever.
  - Spanish language support planned — Phase 1 uses existing STT + TTS. No new brain needed.
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## 1. Who Is Patrick

Patrick Lippy — creator and developer of Scout. NOT a professional programmer. Stroke survivor, dyslexic, blind in right eye, type 1 diabetic.

- Explain everything at screenshot level. Keep messages clear and not visually overwhelming.
  - Always provide full paste-ready files, one at a time — or exact CTRL-F / CTRL-R surgical edits. No snippets. No partial files.
  - Wife: Diana | Son: Elijah (age 9) | Dog: Nicolas. Names must NEVER be hardcoded.
  - Both Claude and ChatGPT are active collaborators. Cross-review welcome.
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## 2. What Scout Is

Scout is a calm family companion robot running on a Samsung Galaxy phone in landscape mode as a permanent face display. Animated eyes, speaks, listens, sees via camera, remembers the family.

- Package: com.example.scoutface | Language: Kotlin + C++ NDK
  - Primary test device: Samsung Galaxy A32 (stress-test, not the benchmark)
  - Dev device: Samsung Galaxy Fold 7 (wireless via WiFi)
  - App: 7-day free trial, then \$9.99 one-time purchase. No automatic charges. No subscriptions. Ever.
  - Brains: TinyLlama 1.1B (offline, always) + user's own free Gemini key (online, optional)
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## 3. Scout's Core Philosophy

Scout should feel: Calm. Thoughtful. Quietly alive. Emotionally subtle. Occasionally curious.

Scout should NOT feel: Excited. Scripted. Fake. Cartoonish. Hyperactive. Constantly praising.

**Stability > Features | Presence > Intelligence | Honest > Fake cheerful | Local-first > Cloud | Predictable > Flashy**

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## 4. What Is Working Right Now

- ✓ Animated face (ScoutFaceView) — thinking expression, iris drift, narrowed lids, asymmetric brows

- ✓ Speech recognition (STT) + Text-to-Speech (TTS)
  - ✓ Camera — face detection, scene labeling (ML Kit)
  - ✓ Gemini API integration (online brain, user's own key)
  - ✓ Memory layers: TruthDb, HabitLayer, PeopleDb, JournalDb, ConversationDb
  - ✓ Intent router — weather, time, greetings, family facts, downloads, IDENTITY, RECALL\_FACT
  - ✓ Flexible teaching — 'my favorite color is teal' → stored. 'What is my favorite color?' → recalled.
  - ✓ TinyLlama 1.1B offline brain — VERIFIED on BOTH A32 and Fold 7
  - ✓ Weather via Open-Meteo — precipitation %, offline-aware
  - ✓ Total offline mode — 'go offline' blocks ALL internet features
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## 5. Known Issues — Do Not Touch Without Discussion

■ **Wake word — Scout responds to EVERYTHING. TV, conversations, background noise. Most urgent fix before launch.**

- Memory recall bug — works only immediately after teaching. Regex in handleRecallIntent() too strict.
  - Hardcoded Gemini API key — Patrick's personal key in MainActivity.kt line 345. Release blocker.
  - Iris jitter (A32 idle) — hardware timing. Fold 7 smooth. Separate from thinking drift (fixed).
  - ScoutFaceView dead code — 2 lines to clean up. Harmless for now.
  - STT name recognition — 'Scout' misheard as 'Gal', 'Scott', 'Out'. Separate session.
  - Live news — neither brain reads live news. Future news feed needed.
  - Barge-in — deliberately disabled. PARKED.
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## 6. Current Priority — Launch Checklist Order

1. Wake word filter — Scout only responds when he hears his name. Read name from TruthDb not hardcoded.
2. Memory recall bug — surgical fix in handleRecallIntent() in MainActivity.kt.
3. Remove hardcoded Gemini API key — wire ApiKeySetupActivity.kt to secure storage.
4. Basic Settings screen — API key entry, offline toggle, robot name display minimum.
5. Startup diagnostics — friendly message if brain, TTS, or STT missing at startup.
6. A32 stability testing — full session on stress-test device. No code. Validation only.

After launch — Update 1.1 and beyond:

- Proposal Sandbox — 'Want me to remember that?' confirm step
  - Permanent vs temporary memory sorting
  - Caring follow-up loop
  - Full mood system wired in
  - Spanish language support — Phase 1
  - Response cleanup layer — post-TinyLlama filter
  - Brain Pack upgrades via Play Asset Delivery
  - Robot renaming in Settings
  - Full Settings screen
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## 7. Working Rules — Always Apply

- Full paste-ready files only, one at a time. No snippets. No partial files.
- Surgical CTRL-F / CTRL-R edits — always specify which file tab to click first.

- Some Scout files have NO indentation. If a search fails, try a shorter unique single-line search.
- Some logic lives in TWO places (updateLife AND scheduleNextFrame) — change both or Scout flickers.
- One safe change at a time. Build and test before the next change.
- Never touch speech, camera, or download systems without explicit discussion.
- Never touch ScoutFaceView casually — it is Scout's visual heart.
- Patrick is not a professional programmer — screenshot-level explanations always.